PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

International Scout II

1971–1980 · Scout II · Traveler · Terra · SSII

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Structural rust first**
  Scouts were never fully galvanized. Corsetti Cruisers says to start with the rear spring mounts, the body mounts and the area under the doors. Structural rust around the rear crossmember or along the inner rockers can mean a full rebuild. Surface rust is manageable.
- [ ] **Look under bedliners and fresh paint**
  In one Scout II rebuild reported on the 4WD Mechanix forum, a previous owner's bedliner reportedly hid so much floor rust that the repair ran past budget. Front fenders, door sills and the tailgate area hold moisture and can hide filler.
- [ ] **Frame cracks at the steering box**
  The frame is prone to fatigue cracks where the steering box bolts on, behind the front spring hangers and at the body mounts. Pull the box (three bolts) or at least inspect the welds, especially on a truck with big tires.
- [ ] **Panel gaps aren't always crash damage**
  Scouts were hand-assembled with wide, uneven gaps even when new. Very uneven panels, doors that won't close properly or messy welds can still point to a bent frame or a poor repair.
- [ ] **VIN tags, title and line ticket**
  Check for a clean title and matching VIN tags on the chassis and body. The line ticket (the factory build sheet) lists the engine, transmission, axles, gear ratio, paint and options. On 1971–76 trucks it's under the hood on the cowl; on 1977–80 trucks it's inside the glove box door. Replacements can be ordered.
- [ ] **Which front axle?**
  Dana 44 axles became standard on all Scout IIs after 1974. Compare the covers: if the front cover is smaller and rounder than the rear, it's a Dana 30. The line ticket also shows the axle, the ratio and whether there's a Trac-Lok rear.
- [ ] **Engine swaps and wiring**
  Many Scouts now have LS or other swaps. Check the wiring, cooling and driveline geometry; Corsetti warns that amateur conversions cause endless electrical and mechanical trouble. Look under the dash and around the firewall for brittle, patched factory wiring.
- [ ] **Diesels and small parts**
  The SD33 diesels are rare and interesting. IH Parts America still lists filters, water pumps and seals for them. Dash pads, gauge clusters and original seat frames are hard to find for any Scout II, so price those in.

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Serial prefix = year**
  1971–72 Scout IIs use G-prefix serials (G425128 onward). From late 1972 the prefix carries a year letter: CGD = 1973, DGD = 1974, EGD = 1975, FGD = 1976, GGD = 1977, HGD = 1978, JGD = 1979, KGD = 1980 (Super Scout Specialists' catalogue ranges).
- [ ] **Line ticket location**
  1971–76 Scout IIs carry a copy of the line ticket under the hood on the cowl cover panel; 1977–80 trucks have it inside the glovebox door. Lost tickets can be reordered from Scout specialists. Use the ticket to confirm engine, transmission, axles, gear ratio, Trac-Lok limited slip and paint.
- [ ] **Codes worth knowing**
  Line-ticket engine codes include 12211 (Nissan SD33 diesel, '76–'79) and 12212 (SD33T turbo-diesel, '79–'80). Transfer-case code 13146 is the Dana 300, which was only fitted in 1980. Front-axle code 02044 is the Dana 44 with disc brakes. The 1978–79 Selective Edition package is code 10992.
- [ ] **Wheelbase and body**
  The standard Scout II is on a 100-in wheelbase. The Traveler (full fibreglass top with a liftgate) and Terra (half-cab pickup) are 18 in longer between the door and the rear wheel well, on a 118-in wheelbase. Super Scout IIs (SSII) have soft doors, a roll bar and a unique plastic grille.
- [ ] **Grille dates the nose**
  1971–72: three horizontal bars. 1973: 14 vertical bars split in the middle. 1974–75: a vertical-bar overlay. 1976 only: a chrome 15-bar three-section grille. 1977–79: two horizontal and three vertical bars. 1980: a one-piece ABS grille in black or silver. Noses get swapped, so check against the serial.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/scout/scout-ii/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks